

I. ORIGINAL STUDY

Double list experiment in Montevideo, Uruguay
(N = 2,688)

Baseline lists: Things experienced in the last six months

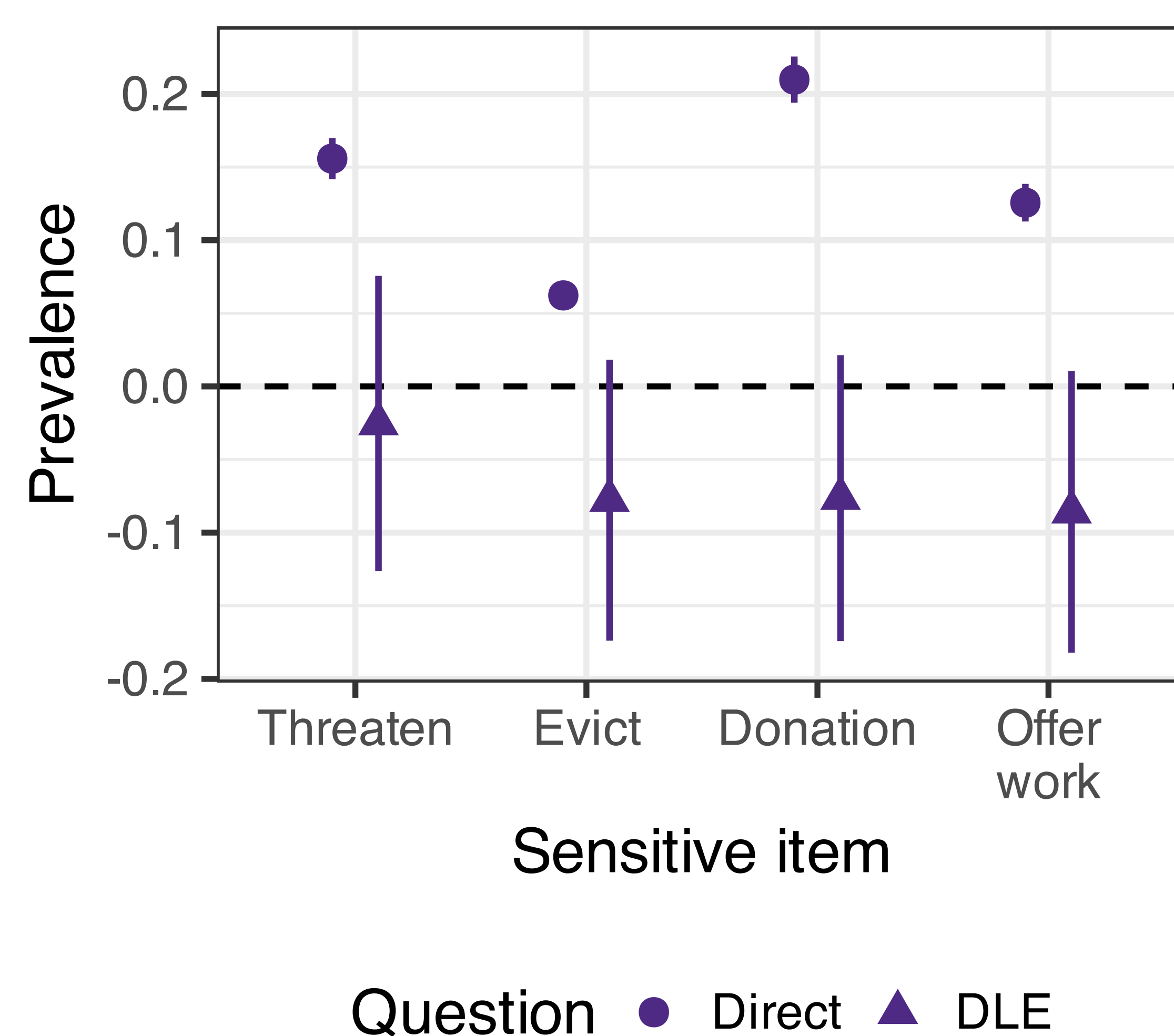
List A	List B
Saw people doing sports	Saw people playing soccer
Visited friends	Chatted with friends
Activities by feminist groups	Activities by LGBTQ groups
Went to church	Went to charity events

Sensitive items: Saw criminal groups...

1. **Threatening** neighbors
2. **Evicting** neighbors from their homes
3. **Making donations** to neighbors
4. **Offering work** to neighbors

Placebo statement: I did not drink mate

II. FAILED ESTIMATES



→ Downward bias on all sensitive items attributable to placebo control

III. RECOVERING INFORMATIVE ESTIMATES

Partial identification approach to recover estimates *without placebo statement*

Sharp bounds: Assume observed data + SUTVA

- Only control responses change
- **Lower bound:** Impute maximum value (4)
- **Upper bound:** Impute minimum value (0)

→ Resulting bounds exceed $[0, 1]$ range

Refinement 1: List experiment assumptions

- Responses only decrease by one unit
- **Lower bound:** Maximum responses (5) decrease
- **Upper bound:** All control responses decrease (unless already zero)

→ Bounds approximate $[0, 1]$ range

Refinement 2: Known placebo proportion

- Auxiliary information on placebo item
- **Lower bound:** Maximum responses (5) decrease
- **Upper bound:** $\hat{\tau}_H = (1 - \delta) \times \bar{V}_{obs} + \delta \times \bar{V}_{max}$
 - δ : known placebo proportion
 - $\bar{V}_{obs}$: LE estimate with observed data
 - $\bar{V}_{max}$: ...with “all decrease by one” data

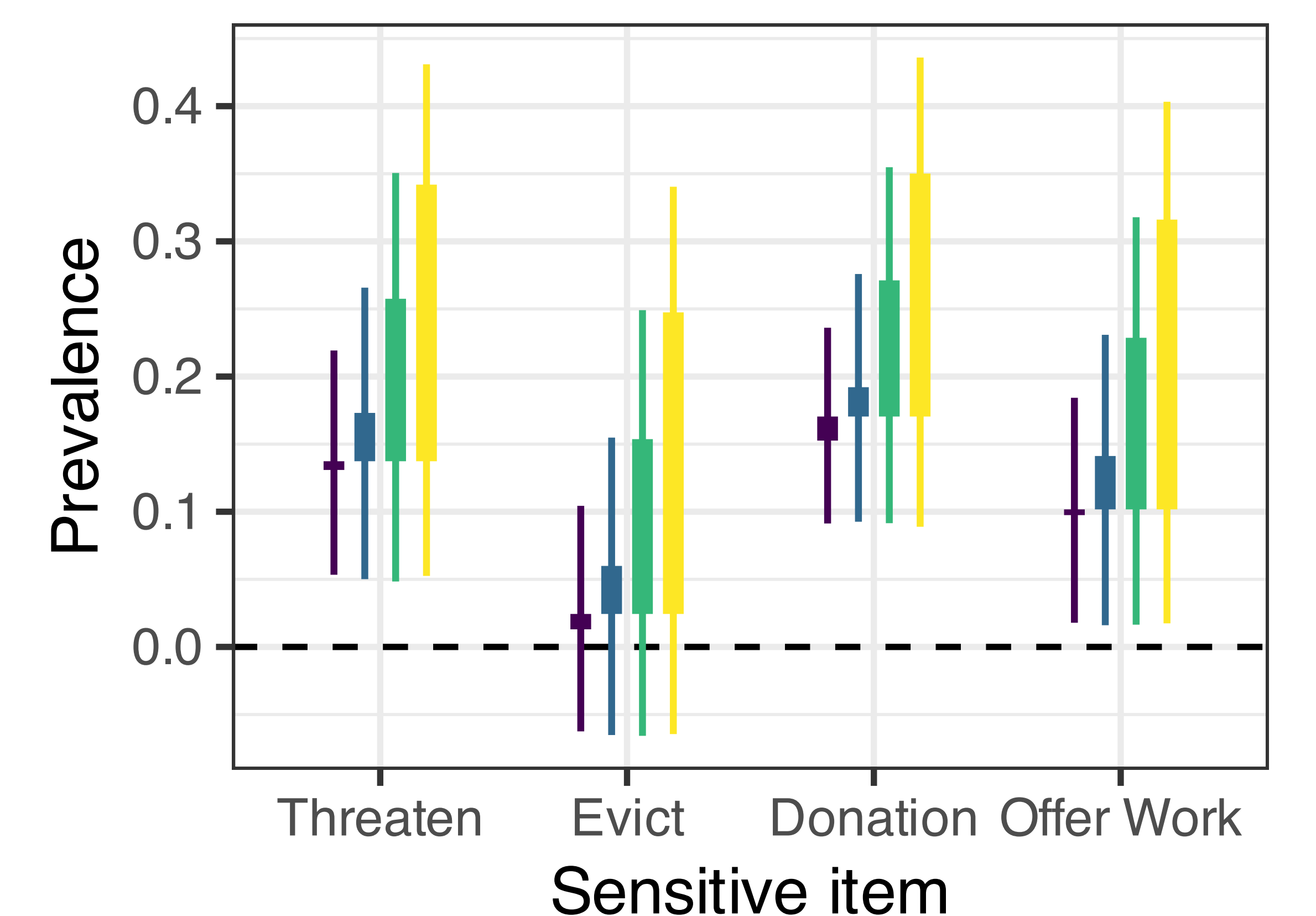
→ Narrows upper bound

Refinement 3: Combine with direct question (Aronow et al 2015)

- **Estimator:** $\hat{\tau}_{comb} = \bar{Y} + (1 - \bar{Y})(\bar{V}_{Y_i=0}^*)$
 - $\bar{Y}$: Prevalence in direct question
 - $\bar{V}_{Y_i=0}^*$: LE estimate among direct = 0

→ Narrows lower bound

IV. RESULTS



V. VALIDATION STUDY

Survey in China (Agerberg and Tannenber 2021)

Target item: Chinese zodiac birth year

→ Crafted so prevalence $\approx 1/6$

Conventional control: No placebo item

Placebo control: Impossible birth year

